

Verb Tenses

The SAT tests your knowledge of the following tenses:

- 1.) Simple**
- 2.) Participle**
- 3.) Perfect**
- 4.) Continuous**
- 5.) Infinitive**

Each of these can be:

- past**
- present**
- future**

- singular**
- plural**

- first-person**
- second-person**
- third-person**

Simple tenses

NOTE: Simple tenses always have a subject

(to be)		Present		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	am	We	are
Second-person	You	are	You	are
Third person	He,She,It	is	They	are

(to be)		Past		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	was	We	were
Second-person	You	were	You	were
Third person	He,She,It	was	They	were

(to be)		Future		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	will be	We	will be
Second-person	You	will be	You	will be
Third person	He,She,It	will be	They	will be

Participle Tenses

	Present	Past
To be	being	been
To have	having	had
To do	doing	done
To read	reading	read
To work	working	worked
To disappoint	disappointing	disappointed

NOTE: Present participles never have a subject and are used exclusively to create a **present participle phrase**

Ex. leaving the office
 reading a book
 having done that already

NOTE: Past participles sometimes have a subject and can be used to create **past participle phrases** when they don't

Ex. left alone by his mother
 read from the altar
 had by many

What's the difference?

Present participle phrases describe actions performed *by the subject*

(Leaving/Left) the bookstore, I headed home.

(Disappointing/Disappointed) my tutor, I decided not to study vocabulary.

Past participle phrases describe things done *to the subject*

(Leaving/Left) by the door, the books were collecting dust.

(Disappointing/Disappointed) by my scores, I decide to study vocabulary.

Perfect Tenses

NOTE: Perfect tenses always have a subject

(to be)		Present		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	have been	We	have been
Second-person	You	have been	You	have been
Third person	He,She,It	has been	They	have been

Present perfect indicates actions performed that began in the past and continued into the present

(to be)		Past		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	had been	We	had been
Second-person	You	had been	You	had been
Third person	He,She,It	had been	They	had been

Past perfect indicates actions performed in the past before something else in the past

(to be)		Present		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	will have been	We	will have been
Second-person	You	will have been	You	will have been
Third person	He,She,It	will have been	They	will have been

Future perfect indicates actions that will have taken place by a certain point in the future

Continuous Tenses

Continuous tenses indicate actions that are continuously taking place.

NOTE: Continuous tenses always have a subject

(to be)		Present		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	am being	We	are being
Second-person	You	are being	You	are being
Third person	He,She,It	is being	They	are being

(to be)		Past		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	was being	We	were being
Second-person	You	were being	You	were being
Third person	He,She,It	was being	They	were being

(to be)		Future		
	Singular		Plural	
First-person	I	will be being	We	will be being
Second-person	You	will be being	You	will be being
Third person	He,She,It	will be being	They	will be being

NOTE: Continuous tenses are not the same thing as present participles. Present participles never have a grammatical subject.

Infinitive tenses

Infinitives are the unconjugated form of a verb, They always begin with the word “to”

NOTE: Infinitives never have a subject.

Infinitive
To be
To have
To do
To read
To work
To disappoint

******NOTE******

Verbs tenses that always have subjects

Simple

Perfect

Continuous

Past participle (when the subject is performing the action)

Verb tenses that never have subjects

Infinitive

Present participle

Past participle (when the action is performed on the subject)